

PIERRE-ANTOINE DESCÔTEAUX

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PROFILE

I'm an ex startup founder and social entrepreneur with experience in sales, operations, partnerships and management in many industries across private and non-governmental sectors. I co-founded an AI software company for mid-market manufacturers and ran the commercial side, going from not knowing the industry all the way through \$300K in signed contracts, six production deployments in a bit more than a year. Before that, I worked in sales and operations, managing CRM functions, accounts activation programming and pitch strategy for a top creative events agency called C2 Studios. I have also created and operated a non-profit in sustainability consulting for universities and have created and run 2 coliving houses for entrepreneurs/creatives in Montreal and Vancouver. Across all these experiences, I am stimulated by learning, service and creating in high-agency teams having a positive impact. I am looking to keep building on my experience in relationship management and innovation through new professional opportunities.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & COO · [Bridge2AI](#)

Vancouver / Montréal ·

2025 to April 2026

- **Company Leadership:** Co-ran an AI software company serving mid-market manufacturers (\$20M to \$200M+ revenue) alongside a technical co-founder, owning commercial strategy, partnerships management and product direction. Came out of Althra accelerator.
- **Codesign Partnership & Sales:** Established large codesign partnerships with RST Instruments and Orica Digital Solutions (BC manufacturer and its parent company) resulting in \$300K in signed contracts through a mix of founder-led sales, discovery, demo and targeted marketing. Managed a pipeline of 10 more factories.
- **Relationships Management & Funding:** established partnerships in the BC tech and manufacturing ecosystems with many organizations such as RBCx, Althra Accelerator, IRAP, University Canada West, Excellence in Manufacturing Consortium and New Venture BC. These partnerships secured us around \$110K in grants and in kind services.
- **Product Roadmap & Discovery:** Ran in-person and online customer discovery directly with plant managers, VP Production, IT teams, production planners and external manufacturing consultants. Using these to validate our hypothesis around desirability, feasibility and viability, informing our product roadmap. Shipped 9 solutions, 6 running in production at customer sites.
- **Commercial Representation:** represented Bridge2AI at various industry events in Canada and the US including Eptech Calgary, Source Canada (Toronto), Palo Alto Hard Tech Meet-up, EMC Vancouver, Web Summit Vancouver and many more smaller local events. Also officially pitched Bridge2AI to many VCs and investors during Althra Demo Day, Investor Day and at other pitch competitions.
- **Marketing & Intelligence:** managed and own marketing activities included but not limited to crafting our UVP, messaging, positioning and competitive research, brand guideline & graphic assets, website, LinkedIn posts, case studies, whitepaper/lead magnets, cold calls and outbound email and LinkedIn marketing campaigns.
- **Media Relations:** Got B2AI featured in EP&T Magazine (established Electronics Manufacturing Media) and named one of Techcouver's 10 B.C. startups to watch in 2026.
- **Flagship Customer Results:** At a \$50M manufacturer with 3,000 active SKUs, cut weekly production planning from 16 hours to 2, reduced lead times by 33%, increased planned capacity by 20% and generated \$80K in annual savings in the first two months.
- **Exited** when my co-founder and I decided to go our separate ways.

Sales Enablement & Operations Specialist · [C2 Montréal](#) / [C2 Studios](#)

Montréal · (promoted from Group Ticket Sales Representative)

2022 to 2024

- **Agency Pitch Development:** Led pitch strategy for RFIs, RFPs, and custom events by conducting in-depth research on client needs, industry trends, and competitive insights; collaborated closely with sales, production, and creative teams to drive tailored enterprise-level proposals and custom solutions. (Accounts include: FIFA, Hannover Messe, ShopTalk)
- **Top-Tier Account Program:** Supported the "XO program", a lead development track for the studio's top leads on \$1M+ accounts, through data management, targeted communications, side events and exclusive tours. The program contributed a \$1.7M increase in weighted pipeline value in the 3 months following the event.
- **CRM Transition Lead (ActiveCampaign to HubSpot):** Managed the end-to-end migration, creating internal buy-in, a data nomenclature and SOPs for CRM usage across teams, and leading training for over 20 users.
- **Automations and Operational Efficiency:** Automated 40% of reporting responsibilities initially assigned to the role, saving over 100 hours annually across the team.
- **Partnerships and Delegations:** Supported account managers on high-profile delegations including La French Tech and Dubai-based clients, and developed personalized programming for VIP clients.
- **Ecosystem Programming:** Organized two editions of "C2 Startup Night" in partnership with EY and Montreal NewTech, bringing around 300 members of the startup community
- **Group Sales:** Exceeded the group ticket sales objective, generating revenues 34% above target by engaging directly with high-value prospects through tailored email marketing and discovery calls.

Founder & Community Manager · The Growth Hub

Vancouver / Montréal ·

2021 to Present

- **Space Creation:** Founded a collaborative living space for entrepreneurs designed to foster innovation, partnership development and shared growth. Operated two properties of 5 to 10 bedrooms each at 96% average occupancy over 5 years, housing residents from 10+ nationalities. Now running at reduced, largely passive scale.
- **Incubation Outcomes:** Five companies were started by residents during my involvement, 2 still active today.
- **Member Selection and Space Design:** Built the resident pipeline, attracting 370 applicants and conducting 90 interviews to select for entrepreneurial potential and cultural fit. Designed each home's interior, furniture, decor and layout to support collaboration.
- **Property Management:** Handled leases, subletting, rent collection, repairs, vendors and turnover across two properties.

Strategist & Innovation Council Member · MaRS Discovery District (MyStartr)

Toronto · 2020 to 2021

- **Product Testing and Research:** Conducted UI/UX testing on MyStartr's employment platform to identify improvements in user experience and accessibility. Designed and tested pilot products with consumers, and guided iterative platform changes from user feedback.
- **Design Workshop Facilitation:** Hosted design events with stakeholders ranging from youth to CEOs, and developed and implemented a content and skill-learning program.
- **Strategy and Executive Advisory:** Informed the development of the organizational strategy for the next 5 years, and advised MaRS' CPO, COO and CEO on how to better engage and attract better and more diverse entry-level talent.

Co-founder & Co-director · RelImagine17

National (Canada) ·

2019 to 2021

- **Non-profit Creation:** Co-founded a Canadian non-profit advancing sustainability in higher education.
- **Program Design:** Developed and co-led RelImagine17's consulting program, designed to support Canadian universities in embedding sustainable practices aligned with the UN's Sustainable Development Goals by fostering campus-wide "Alliances" and building collaborative ESG frameworks.
- **Team and Operations:** Led a team of 9 people at peak, mostly part-time, including hiring, strategic planning, product development, partnerships and general accounting.
- **Partnerships & Funding Pipeline:** Established a long-term funding pipeline by applying to grants, winning pitch competitions and negotiating partnerships with organizations such as SDSN Canada, Colleges and Institutions Canada, four Canadian universities and the Foundation for Environmental Stewardship, resulting in \$300K of capital received over 3 years (120K first year).

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

CAN Youth Network, Co-founder, 2019 to 2020. Co-built a youth-led advisory platform for Canadian government policy, engaging 50,000+ youth nationwide online and contributing to Canada's first youth policy. Partnerships and workshop hosts from [Jack.org](https://jack.org), Health Canada and 2 Federal ministers: Bardish Chagger (Diversity, Inclusion and Youth) and Carla Qualtrough (Employment and Workforce Development).

Sway Accessories, Co-founder and Operations Lead, 2017 to 2018. Registered e-commerce and in-person accessories brand. Designed the product lines, built the brand (assets, photos, etc), ran the Shopify store and the books. +500 sales.

EDUCATION & Programs

- **Althra Accelerator**, Vancouver. Acceleration program for SaaS startups.
- **La Factory**, Montréal. Professional Program in Creative Sciences and Design Thinking.

Formal

- **Royal Roads University**, Victoria BC. Bachelor of Commerce in Entrepreneurial Management.
- **Sophia University**, Tokyo. Academic exchange in international business, languages, politics and history.
- **Université Laval**, Québec. Bachelor of Business Administration, International Management & Sustainable Development

SKILLS

Commercial: Partnership/account development, market/user discovery, proposals, negotiation, marketing & events management

Community: Community engagement, interviewing/selection, event and program design, workshop facilitation, communication

Software: HubSpot, Salesforce, ActiveCampaign, Notion, Zapier/n8n, GDrive, Clay, Apollo, Dripify, Fireflies, Shopify

AI: Claude Code and Claude API as build layer, LLM integration into production workflows, agentic tooling, prompt design

Languages: French (first language), English (native level), Japanese (beginner), Spanish (beginner)